

Lesson 07

Confident Openings



Warm-up

1. Have you ever experienced stage fright?
2. What happened to you during that time?
3. How do you deal with stage fright these days when talking in front of a crowd?



Video

How to Deliver a Knockout Speech

Video Analysis

1. What was the topic of his speech?
2. What impressions do you like about his manner of speaking?
3. How did he introduce his speech topic?
4. What strategies did he use to effectively deliver his ideas?
5. Why is this a great example of delivering your introduction?



Role-Play

Scenario: Two students – Sam and Taylor are talking about their upcoming Public Speaking Class in Business Presentation101 class. They are sharing thoughts about effective ways to start and deliver a persuasive speech.

Sam: Hey Taylor, I'm struggling with how to open my speech effectively. Any tips?

Taylor: Sure! A strong opening really makes a difference. You need a **hook**—something to grab the audience's attention right away.

Sam: Like what?

Taylor: You can use **an attention grabber**—like a question, a surprising fact, or a short personal story. For example, try starting with:

"Good morning, everyone. Have you ever wondered why some companies succeed while others fail?"

Sam: That's catchy. What comes next?

Taylor: Then guide your audience. For example:

*"Today, I'll talk about how strong leadership influences business success. First, I'll introduce the key qualities of good leaders. Next, I'll explain how leadership impacts teamwork and results. Finally, I'll share a few case studies. This presentation will take about 10 minutes. **Let's dive right in.**"*

Sam: That's perfect! You had a clear structure and said how long it would take too.

Taylor: Yep—just remember: a confident opening **sets the tone**. And a good attention grabber makes your audience want to listen.

Sam: Thanks! I'll work on one like that tonight.

Taylor: You'll do great. Practice it a couple of times out loud.

Role-play Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. What is the topic of Sam and Taylor's conversation?
2. What type of attention grabber does Taylor suggest?
3. What phrases are used to show the structure of the presentation?
4. Why does Taylor mention the time of the presentation?
5. Can you think of another example of an attention grabber phrase for your speech?

Discussion

Why is it important for professionals to learn how to open their speech clearly and confidently in the workplace?



Key Phrases

Great public speakers often use *Opening Statements / Introduction Phrases* to grab the attention of their audience.

Examples of these Opening Statements are:

Situation	Phrase	Example
Introducing the topic	<i>To start with.....</i>	Let me talk about increasing sales and allow me <i>to start with</i> that idea that....
Starting with a question	<i>Have you ever wondered.....</i>	Many business organizations fail in their sales goals, and <i>have you ever wondered why this is so?</i>
Introducing a fact	<i>Let me ask you.....</i>	<i>Let me ask</i> here if anybody experiences stage fright in the middle of their speech delivery?
Introducing a statement	<i>Let's dive right in</i>	To understand the different issues affecting our sales today, <i>let's dive right in</i> the root cause of it.



Practice

Choose the best Opening statements from the two examples and write your answer in the box.

Your Answer	Situation	A	B
1. ☐	Someone is introducing the topic	Let me begin by saying that this topic has many factors.	Let me begin that today's topic on "Effective Sales management is important.
2. ☐	Someone is throwing a question to the audience	She has ever wondered why war still happens?	The chaos of the world is unstoppable – have you ever wondered what caused it?
3. ☐	Someone is making an example	This decision has many factors. Let's dive right into the first three reasons.	Another great example of what not to do – is making quick decisions right away.
4. ☐	Someone is giving a quote	Let me share what Albert Einstein said about this issue.	"Choose liberty over death."
5. ☐	Someone is listing the solutions	If you choose this product then it will be useful.	The most defining point of this product is its accessibility.



Production

Open Your Speech!

Work in pairs.

1. Choose a simple topic (e.g., online shopping, teamwork, healthy food).
2. Prepare the opening of a short presentation. Include:
 - A greeting
 - A hook (e.g., question, quote, story)
 - An outline of 2–3 points
 - A phrase showing how long it will take
3. Present your opening to your partner.
4. Listen and give quick feedback: Did they use all the parts?

Suggested topics:

1. The benefits of working from home
2. Why teamwork is important
3. Healthy habits for busy people
4. How to save money effectively
5. The impact of social media on our lives
6. Online learning: Pros and cons
7. Why time management matters
8. The future of technology in daily life
9. Travel tips for first-time travelers
10. The importance of good communication skills



Homework

Rewriting Exercise:

Instructions:

1. Read the opening paragraph of a Research student about the topic of “Plagiarism.”
2. Correct the mistakes found in his speech.
3. Use better Opening Statements in developing his speech.
4. Use key phrases and vocabulary words you learned in this lesson.

Speech Introduction:

Topic: “Effective Methods to Refrain from Plagiarism in Actual Research”

"Good morning, everyone. Today, a crucial topic that affects our integrity and credibility in the workplace: avoid plagiarism. Plagiarism isn't just an academic issue; it can have serious consequences in our professional lives as well. Imagine presenting a project, only to find out that parts of it were copied without proper attribution. This not only damages our reputation. Question - how we can ensure our work remains original and ethical, and why it's essential for maintaining a culture of honesty and respect in our workplace."

IMPROVED VERSION:

Topic: “Effective Methods to Refrain from Plagiarism in Actual Research”